

Question ID: 61f61789

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Problem-Solving and Data Analysis	Ratios, rates, proportional relationships, and units	Hard

Question

To study the moisture content in a group of trees, samples from the trunk of each tree were taken from **25** trees and cut in the shape of a cube. The length of the edge of one of these cubes is **2.00** centimeters. If this cube has a mass of **2.56** grams, what is the density of this cube, in grams per cubic centimeter?

Correct Answer: 0.32, 8/25

Rationale

The correct answer is **.32**. The volume of a cube is given by the formula $V = s^3$, where s is the length of an edge of the cube. It's given that each edge of the cube has a length of **2.00** centimeters. Substituting **2.00** centimeters for s in the formula $V = s^3$ yields $V = (2.00 \text{ centimeters})^3$, or $V = 8.00$ cubic centimeters. It's given that the cube has a mass of **2.56** grams. Dividing the mass, in grams, of the cube by the volume, in cubic centimeters, of the cube gives its density, in grams per cubic centimeters. Therefore, the density of the cube is $\frac{2.56 \text{ grams}}{8.00 \text{ cubic centimeters}}$, or **.32** grams per cubic centimeter. Note that .32 and 8/25 are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.